



STEMZ HEALTHCARE

HR PLAYBOOK

**Your Complete Guide to Workplace Policies,
Benefits, and Professional Standards**

Human Resources Department | Confidential | ForInternalUseOnly

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01 ATTENDANCE & WORKING HOURS

■ Attendance Rules

- Mark attendance on biometric machine at start of shift, during breaks/outdoor exits, and at end of shift.
- WFH entitlement: 1 day/month (not for Trainees, Interns, Customer Service, Global Security).
- HODs: WFH on all Saturdays + 2 additional WFH days/month.
- WFHs to be requested on KEKA at least before 2 working days.
- WFH or outdoor duty: mandatory attendance marking on HRIS (KEKA) on the same day (in-out).
- Late arrival / early leaving: raise formal request on HRIS; first-level approval by Reporting Manager.
- Late beyond 10:00 AM (10 min grace) = late marked; beyond 11:00 AM = half-day automatically.
- Employees can regularize their attendance up to three times in a month.
- Half-day = 4.5 productive hours. Full day deducted if employee reports after 2:00 PM on a half-day approval.
- 3 unapproved late arrivals in a month result in 0.5-day leave deduction. Late under 2 hrs: manager may ask employee to stay back to complete hours.
- Mandatory: 45 working hours Mon–Fri; shortfall deducted from leave; no leave balance = LWP.
- Biometric at front entrance only is valid for attendance; entry through other gates will result in leave being marked.

How to apply WFH on KEKA:

Go to the Home Page → Click on the 'Work from Home' tab → A pop-up window will appear → Select the required dates and submit your Work from Home request.

Link: <https://shpl.keka.com/#!/home/dashboard>

■ Working Hours

- Standard working hours are from 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday to Friday, and on alternate Saturdays. The schedule includes a one-hour break for lunch and tea.
- Flexi working hours, where applicable at the Corporate Office, allow employees to report anytime between 9:00 AM and 10:00 AM and correspondingly conclude their workday between 6:00 PM and 7:00 PM.
- Employees availing flexi working hours are required to keep their reporting manager informed of their intended office timings in advance.
- Working beyond regular office hours and on designated holidays is discouraged. Any work on holidays must be undertaken only with prior approval from the respective HOD.
- Employees are eligible for one Work From Home (WFH) day per month. HODs are eligible for up to two WFH days per month, subject to business requirements and managerial approval.

02 CORPORATE DRESS CODE POLICY

Employees are expected to maintain a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at the workplace. Employees attending client meetings, vendor interactions, candidate interviews, QMC visits, or official external meetings—virtually or onsite—must follow formal business attire.

Clothing with offensive messages, revealing designs, excessive distressing, or attire unsuitable for a professional workplace is strictly prohibited. Any clothing typically worn for workouts, sports, or sleepwear is not permitted.

Men's Dress Code

Category	Acceptable	Non-Acceptable
Tops	Formal shirts, polo/collared T-shirts, sweaters, blazers, jackets	Round-neck T-shirts, tank tops, hoodies, sweatshirts, torn/ripped tops
Bottoms	Formal trousers, pants, proper fitting jeans	Joggers, shorts, sweatpants, workout wear, torn/ripped jeans, pyjamas
Footwear	Formal shoes, business casual shoes, clean sneakers, boots	Slippers, Crocs, torn/dirty shoes
Grooming	Professional appearance, classic ties, neat hairstyle	Extreme hair colours/styles, excessive perfume, earrings, caps/hats

Women's Dress Code

Category	Acceptable	Non-Acceptable
Tops	Formal shirts, blouses, kurtis, sarees, salwar kameez, blazers	Spaghetti/off-shoulder tops, tank tops, backless/low-cut tops, torn/ripped tops
Bottoms	Formal trousers, pants, proper fitting jeans, leggings with long tops, skirts below knee length	Shorts, mini skirts, biker shorts, joggers, workout wear, torn/ripped jeans
Dresses	Dresses below knee length	Off-shoulder or spaghetti strap dresses
Footwear	Formal shoes, sandals, clean sneakers, boots	Slippers, Crocs, torn/dirty shoes
Grooming	Professional makeup, minimal accessories, neat hairstyle	Extreme hair colors, excessive perfume, revealing/transparent clothing, caps/hats

Non-compliance with the dress code may result in corrective action as per company policy.

03 PREVENTION OF SEXUAL HARASSMENT (POSH)

STEMZ is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and inclusive workplace free from sexual harassment, discrimination, and inappropriate behavior. This policy applies to all employees, consultants, interns, trainees, contract staff, and any individual associated with the organization.

■ What Constitutes Sexual Harassment

- Physical contact or advances
- Requests or demands for sexual favors
- Sexually suggestive remarks or comments
- Sharing or displaying inappropriate content
- Unwelcome verbal, non-verbal, written, or electronic communication of a sexual nature

■ Reporting & Investigation

- Any employee who experiences, witnesses, or becomes aware of sexual harassment is encouraged to report the matter immediately.
- Complaints may be submitted to the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), HR, or through the designated POSH reporting channels.
- Complaints should preferably be raised as soon as possible to enable a fair and timely investigation.
- All complaints will be treated seriously, investigated promptly, and handled in a fair, impartial, and confidential manner.
- The organization strictly prohibits retaliation against any individual who raises a concern, files a complaint, participates in an investigation, or supports a complainant in good faith.
- Employees are expected to cooperate fully with any inquiry or investigation conducted under this policy.
- If allegations are substantiated, appropriate corrective and disciplinary action may be taken, including warning, suspension, loss of privileges, demotion, or termination of employment, depending on the severity of the misconduct.
- Deliberately false, malicious, or misleading complaints may also result in disciplinary action after due investigation.
- The identity of the complainant, respondent, witnesses, and all investigation-related information will be kept confidential to the extent permitted by law.
- Employees who are dissatisfied with the outcome of an inquiry may seek further guidance through the available legal or statutory mechanisms as provided under applicable laws.

■ Central ICC Members

Sr.	Employee Name	Role in ICC	Email-Id	Contact Number
1	Ms. Sakshi Rathi	Presiding Officer	sakshir@stemzglobal.com	+91-9717856038
2	Dr. Sulabh Tripathi	Member	sulabht@stemzglobal.com	+91-7669572817
3	Ms. Pratibha Pooja Khare	Member	pratibhak@stemzglobal.com	+91-7974937279
4	Ms. Meenakshi Dhar	Member	meenakshid@stemzglobal.com	+91-7669044943

Sr.	Employee Name	Role in ICC	Email-Id	Contact Number
5	Ms.Sunanda Sarangi	Member	sunandas@stemzglobal.com	+91-7669653703
6	Dr.Vishagan Athimoolam	Member	vishagana@stemzglobal.com	+91-7433552794
7	Mr. LC Jain	External Member	lalchandjain5@gmail.com	+91-9311074162

■ Local ICC Members

Sr.	Employee Name	Role in ICC	Email-Id	Contact Number
1	Shoaib Khan	Member	shoaibk@stemzglobal.com	+91-8929669086
2	Swati Mishra	Member	lucknow.hr@stemzglobal.com	+91-8960356325
3	Payal Shah	Member	kolkata.operationssupervisor@qatarmedicalcenter.com	+91-6290057672
4	Anish Sudhir Jhadav	Member	anishs@stemzglobal.com	+91-8929229155
5	Kumari Ankita	Member	ankitak@stemzglobal.com	+91-8294567890
6	Priya S	Member	chennai.hr@stemzglobal.com	+91-9551395510
7	R V Reju	Member	kochi.hr@stemzglobal.com	+91-9405021730

04 ANTI-HARASSMENT & WHISTLE BLOWER POLICY

■ Anti-Harassment

- STEMZ is committed to a respectful, equal-opportunity workplace free from all forms of discrimination and harassment.
- Harassment includes negative stereotyping, unwelcome sexual advances, racist/religious/sexist slurs, and any conduct creating a hostile or offensive work environment.
- Occasional compliments or consensual voluntary relationships are NOT harassment — but must not cause favoritism or affect productivity.
- Sexual harassment (verbal, physical, or display of suggestive material) is strictly prohibited and will not be tolerated.
- Examples of sexual harassment: unwelcome flirtations/advances, physical or verbal sexual abuse, graphic body comments, sexually degrading words, display of suggestive material, making unwelcome sexual comments in business communications.

All complaints must be promptly reported:

- Email: icc@stemzglobal.com
- In writing to: ICC, Stemz Healthcare, 10th Floor, Emaar Digital Green, Tower A, Sector 61, Gurugram 122011
- Anonymous complaints are accepted; all investigated with utmost confidentiality.
- Grievance Resolution Committee: 3 members (min. 2 women), headed by a woman; submits report to management.

■ Whistle Blower Policy

- Employees may report suspected illegal, unethical, or inappropriate conduct without fear of victimization, discrimination, or retribution.
- Applies to all employees (permanent/contractual), agency employees, contractors, vendors, suppliers, and anyone associated with STEMZ.
- Covered concerns: abuse of authority, breach of contract, data manipulation, financial irregularities/fraud, unlawful acts, deliberate law violations, bribery/corruption, misappropriation of funds.
- NOT for personal grievances or settling scores; malicious allegations attract disciplinary action.
- Include as much detail as possible: nature of malpractice, names, time/place, background, history, and any supporting detail.
- Whistle-blower identity kept confidential; management treats victimization as a serious matter and initiates disciplinary action against perpetrators.

Report to: Line Manager, Department Manager, or compliance@stemzglobal.com

If concern is about Line/Dept Manager: report to dijud@stemzglobal.com (external investigation initiated).

05 DISCIPLINARY ACTION & EMPLOYEE CONDUCT

■ Disciplinary Action

- Initiated by HR Head or Department Heads upon reported misconduct; includes authority to issue show cause or warning letter with or without suspension.
- Show-cause notice: employee given 2 working days to submit written explanation; HRBP reviews explanation and merits.
- Suspension does not break service continuity or affect annual raise date (except salary and statutory benefits during suspension days).
- Dismissed for misconduct: not entitled to notice pay, pay in lieu, or other benefits (except statutory entitlements).

Penalty Level	Action
Level 1	Counselling
Level 2	Verbal Warning
Level 3	Written Warning
Level 4	Salary Deduction
Level 5	Suspension Without Pay
Level 6	Increment Stoppage
Level 7	Grade Reduction
Level 8	Dismissal

■ Employee Misconduct

Misconduct (standard): insubordination, unauthorised absence, habitual late attendance, negligence, leaving without permission, obtaining leave on false pretence, misbehaving with peers, non-adherence to company rules.

GROSS MISCONDUCT — may lead to immediate dismissal without notice or compensation:

- › Theft, fraud, or bribery
- › Sexual harassment
- › Possession of disproportionate assets
- › Furnishing false employment information
- › Drunken / disorderly behavior or gambling on premises
- › Spreading false rumor panic
- › Criminal offence or deliberate safety violations
- › Tapping communications or intimidation
- › Misuse of company name/resources
- › Unauthorized meetings/demonstrations

■ Respecting Diversity & Inclusion

- STEMZ embraces differences in age, colour, disability, ethnicity, gender identity, language, national origin, political affiliation, race, religion, sexual orientation, and other characteristics.
- Diversity initiatives apply to recruitment, compensation, development, promotions, transfers, social programs, and all daily interactions.
- Respectful communication, teamwork, equal participation, and work-life balance are expected from all employees at all times.
- Annual diversity awareness training is mandatory for all employees.
- Any inappropriate conduct against others may result in disciplinary action.
- Employees who feel discriminated against should seek assistance from a supervisor or HR representative.

■ **Gender Sensitivity**

- Use gender-neutral, inclusive language in all official communications and gatherings.
- Behave normally and professionally with all colleagues — minus unwanted touching or offensive language.
- Prohibited: dirty jokes, suggestive photos, sarcasm, harsh tones, gossip, condescending expressions, mood-related stereotypes, physical comments.
- Avoid intrusive personal questions; respect personal space in elevators, corridors, and seating areas.
- Do Not Touch without consent; maintain appropriate distance at all times.
- Workplace miscommunication leads to disciplinary actions, low morale, and loss of respect.

06 ID / ACCESS CARDS & QMC VISITS

- Non-transferable ID cards issued to all employees; must be always carried / worn within office premises. Consistent non-compliance = serious security breach.
- Lost card: Inform HRBP + HOD immediately; replacement charged at 100% card cost.
- Card must be returned to HR SPOCs as part of Full & Final Settlement.
- QMC visits: Send an email to your respective HRBP with the prior approval from respective manager/HOD with date, purpose, entry/exit time, equipment, and team list. HRBP will get approval from Head Medical Operations; notify GSOC and respective location HR SPOC.
- All employees entering QMC must undergo standard security check (pat down + bag search), cooperate professionally with security.
- Corporate office employees are NOT permitted to interact with applicants unless specifically approved by Centre Manager.
- Lab and X-ray room entry: Lab Coat must be worn by all authorized personnel regardless of designation.
- Visitors at corporate office with prior appointments: security checks with reception; visitors without appointment (salespersons etc.) to be discouraged. Meetings in designated Cabins/Conference Rooms only.

07 LEAVES & HOLIDAYS

Leave Type	Entitlement	Accrual	Carry Forward
Casual Leave (CL)	7 days/year	0.58 days/month (1st of month)	Lapses at year-end
Sick Leave (SL)	7 days/year	0.58 days/month (1st of month)	Lapses at year-end
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days/year	1.5 days/month (month-end)	Up to 15 days

■ Key Leave Rules

- Leave year: Jan 1 – Dec 31; pro-rata for mid-year joiners/leavers based on date of commencement.
- EL accrues during probation but can only be availed after formal probation confirmation letter from HR.
- CL & SL: lapse at year-end, cannot be carried forward.
- Unutilized Earned/Annual leave will be carried forwarded to the next calendar year up-to the maximum of 15 leaves (EL/AL)
- Earned leaves can be encashed only at the time of retirement/separation of the employee from the company, at the rate of the Basic salary per month. Any accumulated leave beyond 15 days would be lapsed.
- 33 days of Maximum accumulation in a year is allowed in an employee leave balance.
- Unutilized Annual Leaves are not cashable anytime during the consulting period or at the end of the term.
- Leave must be planned and approved in advance; emergency exceptions approved post-facto by HOD and in some cases by CEO.
- Maternity leave: 26 weeks (min. 6 months service); applicable for adoption/surrogacy.
- Paternity leave: 3 working days within 3 weeks of birth; up to 2 confinements; applicable for adoption/surrogacy.
- Compensatory off: 0.5 day for ≥ 4 hrs on holiday; 1 day for ≥ 6 hrs; must be used within 30 days of accrual; no accumulation or encashment.
- Bereavement leave: 3 days for immediate family (parents, siblings, spouse, children, grandparents, in-laws) for employees with more than 1 year service.
- Absent without intimation >7 days → management may terminate at its sole discretion.
- Leave accrual stops immediately on resignation; all leave during notice period = LWP.

How to apply leaves on KEKA:

Go to the Home Page → There is Tab for Leave Balance → Click on Request Leave → A window will Pop up → Fill in the required details → Select the type of leave → Write a note → Click on the Request Tab.

Link: <https://shpl.keka.com/#!/home/dashboard>

08 INSURANCE BENEFITS

■ IL Take Care – Employee Orientation Guide

STEMZ provides Group Health Insurance through the IL Take Care platform. Employees can access their policy, raise claims, and manage health benefits through the IL Take Care mobile app.

1. Mobile App Registration	Download the IL Take Care app → Enter registered mobile number → Verify via OTP → Access policy, claims, benefits and wellness services.
2. Add Your Policy	Go to Policies > Add Policy → Select Corporate → Choose company name → Enter Employee ID and Date of Birth. For retail/manual policies: enter Policy Number, UHID and DOB.
3. Download E-Card	Open home screen → Select insurance card → Click E-Card → Select member name → Download card. Show E-card at network hospitals for cashless hospitalization.
4. Search Network Hospitals	Go to Network section → Search hospitals using city, pincode, specialty or hospital name → Review network hospital details before admission.
5. Raise a Reimbursement Claim	Go to Manage Claims → Select Register a Claim → Choose policy and patient name → Select claim type (Hospitalization, Pre/Post Hospitalization, OPD) → Upload required documents and bank details → Submit and track status.
6. Cashless Everywhere Facility	Available even in non-network hospitals subject to approval. Raise request at least 48 hours before admission. Provide admission, hospital and diagnosis details.

■ Health & Wellness Benefits

- Tele and Video Consultation
- Chat with Health Experts
- Fitness Challenges and Step Tracking
- Medical Record Upload

- Travel Insurance

Customer Support: Chat Assistance via 'Ask Ria' | Customer Support Number: 1800 2666

09 CAFETERIA FACILITIES

- Designated pantry areas are available across office locations and are equipped with coffee machines, drinking water facilities, microwave ovens, basic utensils, and wash areas for employee convenience.
- The pantry facilities are managed by the local Administration team and may be used during designated lunch and break timings as per local office schedules.
- Employees are encouraged to use the cafeteria and pantry areas in a staggered manner to optimise seating capacity and ensure smooth usage for all. Employees are also expected to maintain cleanliness and hygiene within these areas at all times.
- External visitors, including customers, suppliers, and personal guests, are not permitted access to the pantry areas.
- Visitors may be hosted outside the office premises or at the office cafeteria during lunch hours only, subject to prior approval from the Administration team.

10 TRAVEL REIMBURSEMENT POLICY

■ General Guidelines

- All business travel must be justified (purpose + financial prudence); use video/teleconference for part-day meetings; consolidate multiple meetings into one trip.
- If multiple team members travel to the same event, evaluate whether a single representative suffices.
- All travel requests are raised to the Admin Team via traveldeskt@stemzglobal.com once approved. WhatsApp/informal approvals NOT valid.
- OD status must be applied on KEKA for full-day outside-office travel; biometric entry/exit required for same-day office return.
- Personal vehicle use requires prior HOD approval; reimbursement at approved per-km rates only.
- Claims without bills: written declaration + prior HOD/RM approval required; subject to predefined lower caps; excessive no-bill claims flagged for disciplinary review.

■ Local Conveyance Rates by Band

Band	Permitted Modes	Personal Vehicle Reimbursement
6–8	Metro, app-based taxi, approved rental vehicle; premium category only where justified	Four-wheeler: INR 15/km
4–5	Public transport, metro, app-based taxi, auto, two-wheeler	Four-wheeler: INR 10/km; two-wheeler: INR 7/km
1–3	Public transport, metro, app-based auto / non-premium cab, bike	Two-wheeler: INR 7/km

■ Travel Advances

Band	Daily Advance Limit
Band 6/7/8	Rs. 8,000 per day
Band 4/5	Rs. 5,000 per day
Band 1/2/3	Rs. 3,000 per day

- Request at least 7 working days before travel; must include estimated expense breakdown; approved by Reporting Manager + HOD.
- Settle with original receipts within 7 working days of return; unspent amount refunded promptly.
- Non-submission within stipulated period may affect eligibility for future advances and could lead to disciplinary action.

■ Outstation Travel (Domestic)

Band	Travel Mode	Accommodation/Night
Band 8	Air Economy / Train AC 1-2 Tier	Metro (9k) / non-metro (7k)
Band 6/7	Air Economy / Train AC 1-2 Tier	Metro (9k) / non-metro (7k)

Band	Travel Mode	Accommodation/Night
Band 4/5	Air Economy / Train AC 2 Tier / Deluxe/Volvo	Metro (5.5k) / non-metro (4.5k)
Band 1/2/3	Train AC 3 Tier/Chair Car / Bus / Air on approval	Metro (4k) / non-metro (3k)

Daily Travel Expense –

Band	Daily Cap (INR)	Documentation
8 / designated HODs	6,000 flat per diem	No bills; approved travel dates and declaration required
5–7	4,000	Actuals against bills, up to cap
3–4	2,000	Actuals against bills, up to cap
1–2	1,500	Actuals against bills, up to cap

■ International Travel

- Prior approval from the CEO/MD is mandatory at least 30 days before travel. Requests must include business justification, itinerary, estimated cost, and expected business outcomes.
- Economy class airfare will be applicable for all international travel. Accommodation will be arranged through approved vendors as per the employee band/grade eligibility.
- Employees are responsible for maintaining a valid passport (minimum 6 months validity), obtaining visas, and securing necessary health clearances.
- Required visa documents include passport copy, bank statement, invitation letter, travel itinerary, accommodation details, and any additional documents requested by visa authorities.
- Expenses related to alcohol, personal entertainment, or non-business activities are not reimbursable unless specifically approved by the CEO/MD.
- Employees must comply with all applicable government and company health, vaccination, safety, and quarantine protocols.
- Employees must inform the HRBP, Reporting Manager, and Corporate Security prior to travel. Submission of the Travel Consent Form is mandatory before travel authorization.
- A Post-Travel Report must be submitted within 5 working days of return, and expense claims must be submitted within 1 week.

■ Reimbursement & Approval Process Summary

Submission	Submit completed Travel Reimbursement Form (Annexure 1) via Approval Matrix
Deadlines	Expense claims within 1 week; submitted by 20th = same month payroll; later = next month
Approval	All claims — HOD first. Up to Rs. 3,500 — Head HR additional approval. Above Rs. 3,500 — CEO approval mandatory
Post-Travel	Post-Travel Report (Annexure 3) mandatory within 3–7 working days of return; prerequisite for releasing reimbursements
Final Authority	Head – HR is the final approval authority for all travel reimbursements

11 EMPLOYEE RELOCATION POLICY

- Employees may be transferred or relocated to another location based on business requirements, organizational needs, or career development opportunities.
- Employees selected for relocation will receive a formal transfer or relocation communication outlining the details of the move.
- HR issues transfer letter with copies to immediate manager and concerned location heads; employee released on due date and personnel file transferred.
- Relocation leave: 1 week + temporary accommodation (company guesthouse or hotel per entitlement) up to 2 weeks.
- Travel for dependent family up to economy flight; transportation of goods up to 1 truckload + 1 vehicle.
- One-time settlement allowance on case-to-case approval basis; 1 month brokerage support for new accommodation.
- STEMZ also assists with school admissions for children if required.

Relocation Support May Include:

- › Relocation leave
- › Temporary accommodation
- › Travel assistance
- › Transportation of household goods
- › Vehicle transportation support
- › Settlement assistance (case-by-case)

■ Career Break Eligibility

Eligibility	2 consecutive years of employment + 'Meets Expectations' rating for 2 years + 1 year in current role post-last promotion
Reasons	Higher education, maternity/paternity/adoption, caring for parents/spouse/children in medical/other emergencies
Duration	1–6 months unpaid (higher education breaks may exceed 6 months)
Restrictions	Minimum 3 years between breaks; minimum 2 years' continuous employment required before applying for next career break
Note	Fulfilment of criteria does not guarantee approval; decided case-to-case by management. Return to same or equivalent role subject to availability of opportunity.

12 PROBATION CONFIRMATION & TERMINATION

■ Probation & Confirmation

- All new employees shall be placed on probation for a period of six (6) months from their date of joining.
- Confirmation of employment shall be based on satisfactory performance and will be jointly recommended by the Reporting Manager and the respective HOD upon completion of the probation period.
- HR will initiate probation review workflows through the HRMS portal (KEKA) during the 1st, 3rd, and 6th month of employment.
- In exceptional cases, the probation period may be extended by a maximum of one (1) additional month with the mutual agreement of the Reporting Manager and HOD. Only one extension shall be permitted, following which the employee must either be confirmed or separated from employment.
- During the probation period, either the employee or the Company may terminate employment in accordance with the notice period provisions stated in the appointment letter.
- Earned Leave (EL) shall accrue during the probation period; however, such leave may only be availed after the employee receives a formal confirmation letter issued by HR.

■ Termination & Deceased Employee

- Separation may be initiated in cases of unsatisfactory performance, misconduct, ethical violations, or non-compliance with Company policies. The Reporting Manager and HR shall conduct counselling and provide an opportunity for improvement before further action.
- If performance or conduct does not improve within the defined review period, termination may be initiated by the Reporting Manager in consultation with HR. All termination decisions shall be communicated in writing.
- Applicable notice periods will be as per the appointment letter.
- In cases of serious misconduct, disciplinary violations, or breaches that are incapable of remedy, the Company reserves the right to terminate employment immediately without notice or compensation, subject to applicable laws.
- Compensation and benefits shall cease from the effective date of termination. The Reporting Manager shall ensure return of all Company assets, while the Finance team shall process the full and final settlement.
- In the event of an employee's demise, HR shall coordinate with the family/legal beneficiaries, and Finance shall process all dues, insurance claims, gratuity (if applicable), and final settlement upon receipt of the required documents, including the death certificate.

13 PERFORMANCE REVIEW & REWARDS

■ Performance Review Process

- All employees at STEMZ are covered under the Performance Review Process.
- Every employee will have defined KRAs (Key Result Areas) and role expectations shared during induction and available on KEKA.
- Monthly performance reviews are conducted through KEKA by Reporting Managers and Functional Managers.
- Incentives, wherever applicable, are processed based on approved performance ratings and business policies.
- Increment recommendations are reviewed by Reporting Managers, HODs, HR, and final management authorities before approval.
- Increment letters may be shared through KEKA or directly by the Reporting Manager/HR team.
- Employees can connect with their HRBP or Reporting Manager in case of any clarification regarding ratings, incentives, or increments.

Performance Evaluation Criteria	Details
Goal/KRA Achievement	Measured against defined Key Result Areas
Productivity & Quality of Work	Output quality and efficiency of work delivered
Teamwork & Behavior	Collaboration, attitude, and interpersonal skills
Attendance & Ownership	Punctuality, accountability, and initiative

Annual Increment Factors	
Individual Performance	Primary driver of increment percentage
Role Criticality	Strategic importance of the role to the business
Internal Parity	Equity across similar roles within the organization
Market Benchmarks	External compensation data and industry standards
Business Performance	Overall company financial health and profitability

■ Rewards & Recognition Programme

- This policy applies to all full-time, part-time, and consultant employees at STEMZ.
- Monthly nominations are reviewed by HR, Country Managers, Functional Managers, and leadership teams before finalization.
- Employees involved in serious policy violations, ongoing investigations, or major non-compliance cases may be excluded.
- Recognized employees may receive Certificates, Appreciation announcements, Monetary rewards/incentives, Spot awards or special recognition.

QMC Staff Awards	Central QMC Awards
★ Employee of the Month	★ League of Achievers

- ★ Rockstar of the Role
- ★ Center of the Quarter

- ★ Circle of Excellence
- ★ Rising Leaders
- ★ Eminent Team Player
- ★ Training Excellence
- ★ Hall of Fame

14 ATTENDANCE PROCESS–QMC

■ QMC Attendance Rules

- All employees, consultants, interns, locums, and contractors at STEMZ are required to maintain regular and timely attendance.
- Standard working hours: Monday to Friday — 9 hours/day (including 1-hour break); Saturday — 4.5 hours (including 30-minute break).
- Employees must mark attendance daily through the biometric system at: Shift start, Shift end, Official movement outside office, Return from official work, Break start and end timings.
- In case the biometric system is not working, attendance must be marked manually in the designated attendance register/shared format.
- Employees are allowed up to 3 late coming instances in a month subject to manager approval.
- A grace period of 5 minutes is allowed for up to 2 occasions per month. Repeated late coming beyond permissible limits may lead to leave deduction.
- If daily login hours are below the minimum required working hours, applicable leave deduction or Loss of Pay (LOP) may be applied.
- Sick leave for more than 2 consecutive days must be supported with valid medical documents.
- HR and Payroll teams will review attendance records monthly and process leave deductions, regularizations, or payroll adjustments accordingly.

■ Leave Application Process

- Employees shall raise leave requests in KEKA for approval well ahead of time.
- Reporting Manager shall approve leave only after verifying alternate staffing arrangements and/or requesting the employee to complete any critical tasks as per operational/departmental requirements prior to proceeding on leave.
- In the event of critical work-related requirements, the Reporting Manager shall engage with the employee to communicate the necessity and rationale for not approving the leave request and collaboratively explore alternative leave scheduling options. The leaves should be approved by the reporting manager via KEKA.

How to apply leaves on KEKA:

Go to the Home Page → Tab for Leave Balance → Click on Request Leave → Fill in the required details → Select type of leave → Write a note → Click on the Request Tab.

Link: <https://shpl.keka.com/#!/home/dashboard>

15 OVERTIME (OT) & TIME OFF IN LIEU (TOIL)

■ Overtime Policy

- Overtime (OT) may be scheduled based on business requirements and operational needs.
- This policy applies to eligible full-time employees below the level of Supervisor and Assistant Manager. Consultants are not eligible unless specifically mentioned in their contract.
- Employees should work overtime only after receiving prior approval from the relevant management and HR team.
- Overtime compensation may be provided either as Overtime Payment (OT) or Time Off In Lieu (TOIL), based on business requirements and management discretion.
- Only approved and verified overtime hours will be considered for payment or TOIL eligibility.
- Overtime payments, where applicable, will be processed through payroll as per the company's approved OT rates and payroll timelines.
- Employees must immediately report any discrepancy in overtime records or payments to HR for review.

■ Time Off in Lieu (TOIL)

- TOIL may be granted instead of overtime payment, subject to prior approval from the Reporting Manager and management.
- Employees must obtain approval before working additional hours intended to be compensated through TOIL.
- Accrued TOIL should ideally be utilized within one month of earning it.
- TOIL not utilized within the approved validity period may lapse and cannot be carried forward unless specifically approved.
- Unused TOIL will not be converted into cash or paid out at the time of separation from the organization.
- Employees and managers are jointly responsible for tracking, approving, and utilizing TOIL within the prescribed timelines.

■ OT Process – QMC India, Pasay & Colombo

- Overtime may be assigned only when there is a genuine business or operational requirement.
- Overtime requests are initiated by the Center Manager/Ops Supervisor based on operational needs and employee availability.
- All overtime approvals must be obtained through official email communication or the approved authorization matrix.
- Overtime hours commence only after the employee's regular shift has ended.
- Employees must accurately record their overtime hours through KEKA or the prescribed manual form and obtain the required manager approval.
- Attendance captured through the biometric attendance system will be considered the primary record for calculating overtime hours.
- Overtime payments will be processed as per the applicable country-specific overtime rates and payroll timelines.
- HR and Finance teams will verify overtime records before processing payments.
- In case an urgent business requirement arises at short notice, employees must immediately inform their Reporting Manager or Center Manager before undertaking overtime work.

- Employees working late hours may be provided transportation support where required and approved, to ensure safe travel home.
- Overtime is a business requirement and not an employee entitlement. Approval is subject to operational needs and management discretion.

16 COURIER & MOBILE PHONE POLICY

■ Courier Inward & Outward Process

- STEMZ provides official courier services for business-related documents, parcels, and correspondence through authorized courier partners.
- This facility is available to employees, consultants, and contractors for official business purposes only.
- Employees sending an official courier must ensure that the package is properly packed and provide complete sender and receiver details to the Admin Team.
- Employees should clearly communicate any special delivery requirements (urgent, confidential, etc.) while submitting the courier.
- The Admin Team will arrange pickup, maintain courier records, and provide tracking details whenever applicable.
- All incoming official couriers will be received by the Admin Team and recorded for tracking and audit purposes.
- Incoming couriers will be handed over to the intended recipient on the same working day, wherever possible.
- Personal couriers should not be routed through the company's official courier process unless specifically permitted by local administration.
- STEMZ reserves the right to monitor, record, and audit all official courier transactions to ensure compliance, security, and operational efficiency.

■ Mobile Phone Usage Policy

- Mobile phones, SIM cards, and data services provided by STEMZ are intended strictly for official business purposes.
- Eligibility for company-issued mobile phones or SIM cards is role-based and subject to business requirements and management approval.
- Mobile phone usage is not permitted in applicant-facing or customer-facing areas unless specifically authorized for operational reasons.
- Personal use of company-issued mobile phones, SIM cards, or data services is strictly prohibited.
- Photography, video recording, audio recording, or sharing workplace information using personal or official mobile devices is prohibited unless specifically authorized.
- Employees must immediately report the loss, theft, or damage of any company-issued mobile phone, SIM card, or device to their Reporting Manager and HR.
- Any company-issued mobile phone, SIM card, or related equipment must be returned upon transfer, role change, or separation from the organization.
- Misuse of company-issued mobile devices, unauthorized usage, breach of confidentiality, or violation of this policy may result in disciplinary action, including recovery of costs wherever applicable.

Authorized employees carrying mobile phones must:

- › Use them only for official purposes
- › Keep devices on silent or discreet ringtones
- › Protect devices with a PIN, password, or biometric lock
- › Maintain confidentiality of company information at all times

17 UNIFORM & EMPLOYEE LOCKER POLICY

■ Uniform Policy

- Employees are expected to maintain a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance while representing STEMZ.
- The prescribed uniform must be worn by employees in customer-facing, applicant-facing, medical, operational, and other designated roles as communicated by the company.
- Standard uniform entitlements may include shirts, trousers/skirts, ties/bows, and other role-specific items as determined by the company.
- Certain roles may be provided with additional items such as blazers, jackets, sweaters, laboratory coats, or protective clothing based on operational requirements.
- Employees are responsible for maintaining, cleaning, and properly caring for their uniforms and ensuring required alterations are completed, if applicable.
- Footwear must be professional, clean, and suitable for the work environment. Employees are generally responsible for arranging their own footwear unless otherwise specified.
- Employees may wear approved religious or cultural attire (such as headscarves/hijabs) provided it aligns with workplace safety and professional standards.

■ Uniform Reissue & Recovery Guidelines

- Employees are entitled to a replacement uniform set after completing 12 months from the date of the previous uniform issuance.
- Blazers, jackets, or similar role-specific items may be reissued once every two years or as per business requirements.
- If a uniform is damaged due to a workplace accident or circumstances beyond the employee's control, the company may approve an early replacement after review.
- Any replacement required due to loss, negligence, misuse, or personal reasons may be at the employee's expense.
- Uniforms remain the property of STEMZ and may be required to be returned upon transfer, role change, or separation from the organization.
- Employees leaving the organization before completing the prescribed service period may be subject to uniform cost recovery from their Full & Final Settlement.
- Pregnant employees may request a larger uniform size or wear suitable professional attire that ensures comfort while maintaining workplace standards.

■ Employee Locker Usage Policy

- STEMZ provides lockers to employees, wherever available, for the safe storage of personal belongings during working hours.
- Lockers are allocated by the Administration or HR team and remain the property of the company at all times.
- Employees must not share locker keys, duplicate keys, or allow unauthorized access to their assigned locker.
- Lockers should only be used to store personal items such as mobile phones, uniforms, handbags, and other day-to-day essentials.
- Employees should not store cash, valuable jewelry, electronic gadgets, or other high-value personal items in lockers. The company will not be responsible for loss, theft, or damage of personal belongings.

- Food, beverages, perishable items, and waste materials must not be stored inside lockers.
- The company reserves the right to inspect lockers at any time for security, safety, compliance, or operational reasons.
- Employees must remove all personal belongings from lockers upon transfer, relocation, or separation from the organization.
- Failure to comply with locker usage guidelines or misuse of company-provided lockers may result in disciplinary action as per company policy.

18 REIMBURSEMENT GUIDELINES

- Employees may claim reimbursement only for approved business-related expenses incurred while performing official duties.
- All reimbursement claims must be supported by valid bills, receipts, invoices, and any required approvals.
- Unauthorized expenses, personal expenses, penalties, fines, parking violations, or non-business-related costs will not be reimbursed.
- Employees must submit reimbursement claims within the prescribed timelines. Delayed submissions may result in rejection of the claim or adjustment of any advance provided.
- Travel, accommodation, meal, entertainment, gifting, and other business expenses must comply with the applicable company policies and approval requirements.
- Any exception to the reimbursement policy requires prior approval from the appropriate management authority.
- The Finance team will process approved reimbursement claims as per the company's payment cycle and standard timelines.
- Submission of inaccurate, misleading, or unsupported reimbursement claims may result in disciplinary action as per company policy.

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